

Pacific Reef Research Institute

Phase III Coral Reef Health Monitoring Program
Interim Progress Report | September 2025 - January 2026
Report Date: February 7, 2026 | Grant: CCF-2023-HI-0047
Principal Investigator: Angela Marie Peterson, PhD

1. Executive Summary

Phase III monitoring is progressing as planned. Field activities from September 2025 through January 2026 covered four sites: Hanauma Bay (Stations A-C), Waikiki Reef (Stations A-C), and Lanai Lookout (baseline established December 2025). A significant finding is the continued bleaching trend at Waikiki Reef Station C (5.1% bleaching in November, increasing to 6.2% in January), which has triggered increased monitoring frequency and formal CCF notification.

2. Field Activities

September 2025: Baseline Q1 surveys, Hanauma Bay A/B and Waikiki Reef A/B. Elevated temps at Waikiki (27.5 C). All transects QC-verified.

October 2025: Expanded to Hanauma Bay C (43.2% live coral). Waikiki temps moderating (26.9 C).

November 2025: Station C first bleaching flag: 5.1% at 25.9 C. Alert memo issued to Dr. Palani and CCF contact.

December 2025: Excellent conditions at Hanauma Bay (44.0% live coral, Station C). Lanai Lookout Station A baseline established: 37.2% live coral.

January 2026: Station C bleaching at 6.2%. Formal alert protocol review initiated. Two dives cancelled Jan 29 (adverse sea conditions); reschedule pending coordination.

3. Key Findings

Hanauma Bay: Live coral 38-44%, bleaching below 2%. No adverse trend.

Waikiki Reef Station C (ALERT): Bleaching 5.1% (Nov) -> 6.2% (Jan). Exceeds 5% threshold. Monitoring frequency increased to bi-monthly. Formal alert filed.

Lanai Lookout: Baseline established Dec 11, 2025. Cover 37.2%, bleaching 2.4%.

4. Budget Status (through January 31, 2026)

Direct salaries (PI + staff)	\$68,400	\$52,240	\$16,160
Field equipment / supplies	\$18,200	\$14,890	\$3,310
Dive operations / boat fees	\$22,400	\$19,650	\$2,750
Lab and data processing	\$12,800	\$11,200	\$1,600
Outreach program costs	\$9,400	\$8,810	\$590
Travel (conferences)	\$5,800	\$5,800	\$0
Indirect costs (28%)	\$5,500	\$4,850	\$650
TOTAL	\$142,500	\$117,440	\$25,060

Category

5. Upcoming Milestones

- February 2026: Waikiki Reef C bi-monthly dive (bleaching status update)
- February 2026: CCF formal progress report submission
- February 2026: Community Reef Walk at Hanauma Bay (outreach event)
- February 2026: Coral Reefs journal galley corrections due

6. Certification

I certify that the information in this report is accurate and complete, and that all expenditures are consistent with the terms of CCF grant agreement CCF-2023-HI-0047. Research activities comply with DLNR Special Use Permit HI-DLNR-MR-2023-047 and PRRI Institutional Animal Care and Use Protocol.

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